



HIS GLOBAL CONCLAVE  
UNITED NATIONS DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME  
UNDP BACKGROUND GUIDE

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TOPICS:

Topic 1: Automation, AI and Future of Work

Topic 2: Women's Economic Empowerment

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## SECTION I | HISTORY OF THE COMMITTEE

The **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** has a rich history rooted in the broader context of post-World War II international cooperation. Established officially in **1965**, the UNDP emerged from earlier initiatives aimed at providing technical assistance and financial support to developing nations. In the early **1960s**, discussions arose about merging these two entities to streamline efforts and avoid duplication. This led to the establishment of the UNDP.

The UNDP's primary mission is to help countries eliminate poverty and achieve sustainable human development. It focuses on:

- **Economic Growth:** Encouraging policies that foster economic development while ensuring environmental sustainability.
- **Human Development:** Promoting social equity and improving quality of life for all citizens.
- **Capacity Building:** Developing local skills and institutions to ensure long-term self-sufficiency.

In recent years, the UNDP has played a crucial role in implementing the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** established in 2015, which aim to address global challenges such as poverty, inequality, and climate change. The UNDP also coordinates various UN agencies through the **United Nations Development Group (UNDG)**, enhancing collaboration at the country level.

Overall, the UNDP continues to adapt its strategies to meet evolving global challenges while remaining committed to its foundational goals of poverty eradication and sustainable development.

**Core Principle:** Gender equality is a fundamental commitment for the UNDP, recognized as essential for sustainable development and human rights. The organization aims to eliminate legal, social, and economic barriers that hinder women's empowerment.

**Gender Equality Strategy:** The UNDP's Gender Equality Strategy 2018-2021 outlines its roadmap for integrating gender considerations into all areas of its work. This strategy emphasizes the need for structural changes that accelerate gender equality and women's empowerment, aligning with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

**AI as a Tool for Development:** UNDP champions the use of AI to accelerate progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). The organization emphasizes that AI should be developed and utilized in ways that promote human rights, equality, and justice, ensuring that its benefits reach all segments of society.

**Digital Strategy:** In 2020, UNDP launched a new Digital Strategy aimed at enhancing digital capacities within governments and organizations. This strategy includes building understanding of AI technologies and their application in achieving development goals while addressing associated risks.

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## SECTION II | INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA

### Automation, AI, and the Future of Work

The advent of automation and artificial intelligence (AI) is transforming the landscape of work, presenting both challenges and opportunities. As these technologies advance, they are reshaping industries, redefining job roles, and altering the very nature of employment. This essay explores the implications of AI and automation on the future workforce, focusing on job displacement, job creation, skill demands, and the evolving workplace dynamics.

#### Job Displacement vs. Job Creation

One of the most significant concerns surrounding AI and automation is the potential for job displacement. Critics argue that as machines take over routine and repetitive tasks, many jobs will become obsolete. This trend is already evident in sectors like manufacturing, where robots have replaced human workers on assembly lines, and in customer service, where AI-driven chatbots handle inquiries previously managed by human

However, history suggests that technological advancements often lead to new job creation alongside displacement. While some roles may vanish, new positions requiring human intelligence, creativity, and emotional skills are likely to emerge

#### Skills for the future with AI

**Emerging Skill Demands** The integration of AI necessitates a workforce equipped with new skills. As automation takes over mundane tasks, there is a growing demand for expertise in areas such as data science, machine learning, and AI system maintenance.

Furthermore, soft skills like creativity, critical thinking, and emotional intelligence are becoming increasingly valuable as they complement technological capabilities.

To prepare for this shift, educational institutions and organizations must invest in reskilling and upskilling programs that focus on both technical and soft skills. This proactive approach will enable workers to transition into new roles created by the evolving job market.

#### Changes in Workplace Dynamics

AI's role in the workplace can be understood through two lenses: augmentation and automation. While automation replaces human labor for specific tasks, augmentation enhances human capabilities by providing tools that improve efficiency.

For instance, generative AI tools can assist employees by streamlining information processing or generating insights that facilitate decision-making.

This dual approach suggests a future where humans and machines work together more harmoniously.

WorkplaceStructure

As intelligent machines become more integrated into daily operations, workplace structures will evolve. Traditional work ows will adapt to accommodate both human workers and automated systems. For example, self-checkout kiosks in retail allow cashiers to shift from transactional roles to customer service positions that require interpersonal skills.

This evolution emphasizes the need for exible work environments that support collaboration between humans and machines.

## Goals

Building Digital Capacity: Enhancing understanding of AI's potential and risks for achieving the Sustainable Development Goals

Ethical AI: Addressing ethical issues associated with AI deployment in international development contexts

## Women'sEconomicEmpowerment

Investing in women's economic empowerment has a direct impact on gender equality, poverty eradication, and inclusive economic growth. Women contribute signi cantly to economies through various roles—whether as entrepreneurs, employees, or caregivers—but they often face systemic barriers that limit their economic participation. These barriers include:

- Discrimination: Women frequently encounter gender-based discrimination in the workplace, resulting in lower wages and limited career advancement opportunities
- Access to Resources: Women have less access to nancial assets, loans, and land, which restricts their ability to start and grow businesses
- Unpaid Care Work: The disproportionate burden of unpaid domestic work limits women's time and capacity to engage in paid employment

## Economic Impact

Research indicates that enhancing women's economic rights can lead to substantial economic growth. For instance:

- Closing the gender gap in labor force participation could boost the global economy by approximately \$7 trillion
- Studies suggest that increasing women's participation in the workforce can lead to higher GDP growth rates, particularly in developing countries

Moreover, companies that prioritize gender diversity in leadership roles tend to perform better financially. Organizations with more women in senior management positions often experience improved productivity and enhanced organizational effectiveness

## Treaties

Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action (1995): A comprehensive policy agenda for women's empowerment that UNDP supports through various programs

The Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW): is an international treaty adopted in 1979 by the United Nations General Assembly, the Convention recognizes gender equality and prohibits discrimination against women in all spheres, including the private and public spheres.

The Declaration on the Elimination of Violence against Women in the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN): Region is a political declaration made in June 2004 in Jakarta and signed by the ten ASEAN member countries. This declaration reaffirms the commitment of the ten signatory countries to eliminate violence against women, in line with CEDAW and the 1995 Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, through further regional and bilateral cooperation.

The International Labor Organization Convention No. 190 on Violence and Harassment: is an international convention adopted in June 2019, aimed at eliminating violence and harassment at work. This convention recognizes that violence and harassment can affect all workers, both men and women

## Key Initiatives and Strategies

Several organizations are actively working to promote women's economic development:

- UN Women: Focuses on creating programs that help women secure decent jobs, accumulate assets, and influence public policies. Their initiatives often target marginalized groups such as rural women and domestic workers
  - Bloomberg Philanthropies: Partners with various sectors to create educational and training programs for women, leading to increased economic independence. Since 2007, over 779,000 women have benefited from these initiatives
  - Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation: Aims to remove barriers that prevent low-income women from participating fully in the economy. Their strategy includes improving access to capital and financial services for women entrepreneurs.
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## SECTION III | KEY TERMS

UNDP: United Nations Development Programme

SDGs: Sustainable Development Goals

Human Development Report: An annual report published by UNDP that provides data and analysis on human development indicators

MDGs: Millennium Development Goals

Human Development: A holistic approach focusing on improving people's well-being and expanding their capabilities rather than just economic growth

Capacity Development: Efforts aimed at enhancing the abilities of individuals, organizations, and societies to manage their own development effectively.

HDI: Human Development Index

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## SECTION IV I CLOSING REMARKS

As delegates of the 1st Hindustan International School Global Conclave, you are responsible for representing your country, doing proper research on the above topics

This session presents you with the opportunity to showcase your debating abilities, diplomacy, critical and analytical skills and the ability to collaborate with other delegates

Good luck delegates

Regards,

The UNDP, executive board

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